

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CLF-C02, latest version) in detail, so we clearly understand what it is, why it matters, and how to prepare.

What is AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner?

- **Entry-level AWS certification** designed for individuals with no prior deep cloud/technical expertise.
- It **validates foundational knowledge** of AWS Cloud, its global infrastructure, basic services, billing, security, and pricing models.
- Ideal for **beginners, managers, sales/marketing teams, and non-technical professionals** who want to understand AWS at a business + technical level.

Who Should Take It?

- People **new to the cloud** (IT or non-IT background).
- **Managers / Project Leads / Finance / Sales professionals** who work with AWS teams.
- **Aspiring Cloud Engineers, DBAs, DevOps, or Developers** as a first step before role-based certifications (Solutions Architect, SysOps, DevOps Pro).

Exam Overview

- **Exam Code:** CLF-C02 (latest update).
- **Format:** Multiple-choice, multiple-response.
- **Duration:** 90 minutes.
- **Cost:** \$100 USD (sometimes discounts available with vouchers).
- **Delivery:** Pearson VUE or PSI testing centers, or **online proctored**.
- **Passing Score:** 700/1000.
- **Languages:** English, Japanese, Korean, Simplified Chinese, French, German, Italian, Portuguese, Spanish, Indonesian, Thai, Vietnamese.

Exam Domains (CLF-C02 – Updated Blueprint)

1. **Cloud Concepts (24%)**
 - Benefits of cloud computing
 - AWS global infrastructure (Regions, AZs, Edge locations)
 - Shared Responsibility Model
 - Six advantages of cloud (scalability, elasticity, high availability, etc.)
2. **Security and Compliance (30%)**
 - AWS IAM basics (users, roles, policies, MFA)
 - Security support (AWS Shield, WAF, KMS, CloudTrail, GuardDuty)
 - Compliance programs and shared responsibility
3. **Cloud Technology and Services (34%)**
 - Core services:
 - Compute: EC2, Lambda, Elastic Beanstalk
 - Storage: S3, EBS, EFS, Glacier
 - Databases: RDS, DynamoDB, Redshift
 - Networking: VPC, CloudFront, Route 53, ELB
 - Containers (ECS, EKS, Fargate)
 - Serverless basics
 - Well-Architected Framework principles
4. **Billing, Pricing, and Support (12%)**
 - AWS Pricing Models (On-Demand, Savings Plans, Spot, Reserved)

- TCO Calculator & Pricing Calculator
- AWS Free Tier
- Support plans (Basic, Developer, Business, Enterprise)

Difficulty Level

- Considered **easy to moderate**.
- No deep hands-on needed, but you should know **key AWS services, concepts, and pricing basics**.
- Often taken as **first AWS cert** before moving to **AWS Solutions Architect Associate (SAA-C03)**.

Preparation Guide

1. **AWS Free Training**
 - [AWS Cloud Practitioner Essentials \(free digital course\)](#)
 - AWS Skill Builder practice resources.
2. **Whitepapers**
 - AWS Well-Architected Framework.
 - Overview of AWS Cloud Adoption Framework.
 - AWS Security Best Practices.
3. **Practice Tests**
 - Use **Whizlabs, Tutorials Dojo (Jon Bonso)**, or ExamPro practice exams.
 - AWS Official practice exam (\$20).
4. **Hands-On (Optional but Recommended)**
 - Free Tier account – play with **S3 bucket, EC2 instance, IAM users, RDS**.

Benefits of AWS Cloud Practitioner

- Adds **credibility to your resume** – shows you understand cloud basics.
- Opens door to **higher AWS certs** (Architect, Developer, SysOps).
- Good for **career switchers** moving from DBA, SysAdmin, QA, Networking → Cloud.
- Helps **non-technical roles** (sales, business analysts, product managers) communicate better with cloud engineers.

Suggested Learning Path After Cloud Practitioner

- **AWS Solutions Architect Associate (SAA-C03)** → deeper into design and architecture.
- Then specialize:
 - **Database Specialty** (if you're DBA background).
 - **Security Specialty** (if you're compliance/security focused).
 - **DevOps Engineer Professional** (if you move towards automation & CI/CD).

30-Day Study Plan for AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CLF-C02).

This will be a **daily roadmap (1 hour/day avg.)** mixing theory, practice, and mock exams so you're fully ready in one attempt.

30-Day AWS Cloud Practitioner Study Plan

Week 1 – Foundation & Cloud Concepts

Goal: Understand cloud basics, AWS global infrastructure, and advantages.

- **Day 1:** Intro to Cloud Computing & AWS overview (IaaS, PaaS, SaaS, Public vs Private vs Hybrid).
- **Day 2:** AWS Global Infrastructure (Regions, AZs, Edge Locations, Local Zones, Outposts).
- **Day 3:** Benefits of AWS Cloud – Scalability, Elasticity, High Availability, Fault Tolerance.
- **Day 4:** Shared Responsibility Model (AWS vs Customer responsibilities).
- **Day 5:** Well-Architected Framework – 6 pillars (Operational Excellence, Security, Reliability, Performance Efficiency, Cost Optimization, Sustainability).
- **Day 6:** Read **AWS Cloud Adoption Framework (CAF)** whitepaper (summary notes).
- **Day 7:** Quick quiz + hands-on: Create a Free AWS account, explore AWS Management Console.

Week 2 – Core AWS Services

Goal: Get familiar with Compute, Storage, Networking, and Database services.

- **Day 8:** Compute – EC2 basics (instances, AMIs, pricing models), Auto Scaling, Elastic Load Balancer.
- **Day 9:** Serverless – AWS Lambda, Elastic Beanstalk, Fargate (concept only).
- **Day 10:** Storage – S3 basics (buckets, objects, storage classes, versioning, lifecycle).
- **Day 11:** Block & File storage – EBS, EFS, FSx, Glacier.
- **Day 12:** Databases – RDS, Aurora, DynamoDB, Redshift (use cases).
- **Day 13:** Networking – VPC basics, Subnets, Route 53, CloudFront, API Gateway.
- **Day 14:** Hands-on mini-lab: Launch an EC2, connect via browser, store a file in S3, create a DynamoDB table.

Week 3 – Security, Billing & Support

Goal: Understand IAM, Security Tools, Pricing, and Support Plans.

- **Day 15:** IAM basics – Users, Groups, Roles, Policies, MFA.
- **Day 16:** Security services – AWS KMS, CloudTrail, CloudWatch, GuardDuty, Inspector, Shield, WAF.
- **Day 17:** Compliance frameworks (HIPAA, PCI DSS, GDPR, SOC).
- **Day 18:** AWS Pricing Models – On-Demand, Reserved, Spot, Savings Plans.
- **Day 19:** Free Tier & Cost Explorer, AWS Pricing Calculator.
- **Day 20:** AWS Support Plans – Basic, Developer, Business, Enterprise.
- **Day 21:** Quiz + hands-on: Create IAM user with MFA, simulate billing alerts in AWS Budgets.

Week 4 – Review, Practice & Mock Exams

Goal: Reinforce learning, practice, and pass exam confidently.

- **Day 22:** Review Cloud Concepts (Week 1 notes).
- **Day 23:** Review Core Services (Week 2 notes).
- **Day 24:** Review Security, Billing, Support (Week 3 notes).
- **Day 25:** Whitepapers review – Security Best Practices + Well-Architected.
- **Day 26:** Practice Exam #1 (AWS Official Practice Exam or Tutorials Dojo).
- **Day 27:** Analyze mistakes from exam, re-study weak areas.
- **Day 28:** Practice Exam #2 (Whizlabs/ExamPro).
- **Day 29:** Flashcards & revision – key definitions, pricing, global infra.
- **Day 30:** Final Mock Exam + Confidence Boost.

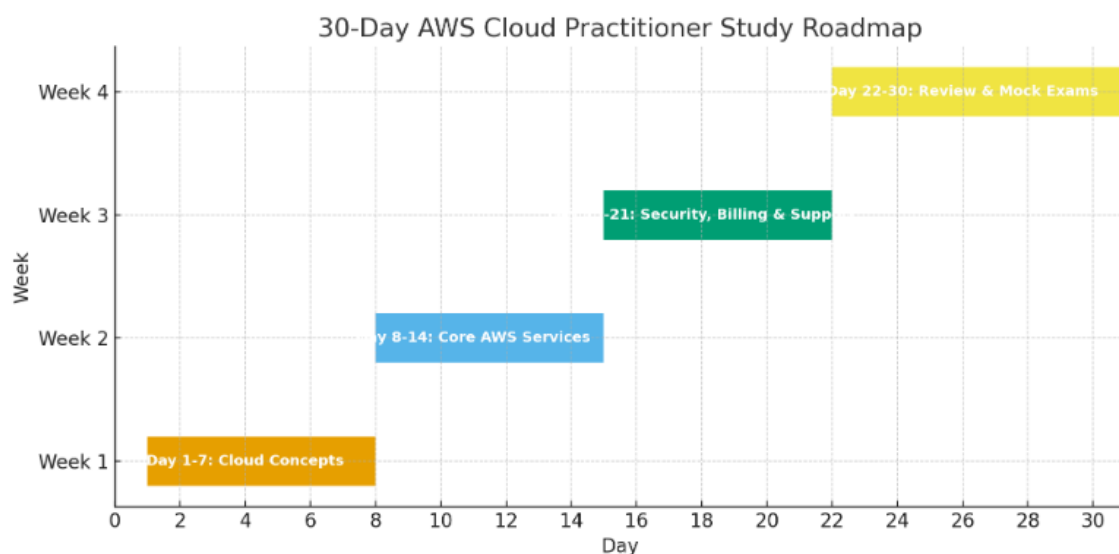
Recommended Resources

- **Free:**
 - AWS Cloud Practitioner Essentials (free digital course).
 - AWS Whitepapers: Well-Architected, Security Best Practices, CAF.
 - AWS Skill Builder – free quizzes.
- **Paid (optional, but very helpful):**
 - Tutorials Dojo (Jon Bonso) Practice Tests (~\$10–15, Udemy).
 - ExamPro Cloud Practitioner video course.
 - Whizlabs practice tests.

Strategy on Exam Day

- Read questions carefully – AWS often uses “**most cost-effective**” vs “**highly available**” wording.
- Eliminate wrong answers first.
- Don’t leave blanks – there’s no negative marking.
- Manage time: 90 minutes is more than enough if you stay calm.

Here’s your **visual Gantt-style roadmap** for the 30-day AWS Cloud Practitioner study plan. Each bar shows the week’s focus with its day range.



AWS Cloud Practitioner - 30 Day Study Checklist

Day	Topic	Done
1	Intro to Cloud Computing & AWS Overview	■
2	AWS Global Infrastructure (Regions, AZs, Edge)	■
3	Benefits of AWS Cloud (Scalability, Elasticity, HA)	■
4	Shared Responsibility Model	■
5	Well-Architected Framework (6 Pillars)	■
6	AWS Cloud Adoption Framework (CAF)	■
7	Quiz + Hands-on: Explore AWS Console	■
8	Compute: EC2 basics, Auto Scaling, ELB	■
9	Serverless: Lambda, Elastic Beanstalk, Fargate	■
10	Storage: S3 basics (buckets, lifecycle, classes)	■
11	Block & File Storage: EBS, EFS, Glacier	■
12	Databases: RDS, Aurora, DynamoDB, Redshift	■
13	Networking: VPC basics, Route 53, CloudFront	■
14	Hands-on mini-lab: EC2 + S3 + DynamoDB	■
15	IAM basics: Users, Groups, Roles, MFA	■
16	Security services: KMS, CloudTrail, GuardDuty, Shield	■
17	Compliance frameworks (HIPAA, GDPR, SOC, PCI DSS)	■
18	Pricing Models: On-Demand, Reserved, Spot, Savings Plans	■
19	AWS Free Tier, Cost Explorer, Pricing Calculator	■
20	AWS Support Plans: Basic, Developer, Business, Enterprise	■
21	Quiz + Hands-on: IAM + Billing Alerts	■
22	Review Cloud Concepts (Week 1)	■
23	Review Core Services (Week 2)	■
24	Review Security, Billing, Support (Week 3)	■
25	Review AWS Whitepapers (Security, Well-Architected)	■
26	Practice Exam #1	■
27	Re-study weak areas from Exam #1	■
28	Practice Exam #2	■
29	Flashcards + Revision (Key Terms & Services)	■
30	Final Mock Exam + Confidence Boost	■